Latin *simītū, simītur,* SEIMITVM ‘at the same time, together’

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Abstract: OLat. *simītū* ‘at the same time’ is traditionally interpreted as abl. sg. (originally instr. sg.) of a compound, with first member **sem-* ‘one’ and second member **eitu-* (< PIE **h₁éi-tu-* ‘going’), thus ‘with/at a single go’. The semantics are impeccable, but formal considerations suggest rather a univerbation of a phrase (pre-Lat.) **semi eitū(d)* or **seme eitū(d)* ‘id.’, whence (with elision and univerbation) **sem’eitū(d)* and eventually *simītū.* If correct, this would provide a rare instance of inflected **sem-* ‘one’ (cf. univerbated **smih₂ ǵh(e)slih₂ > mīlia* ‘thousands’), otherwise eclipsed by **(h₁)oi-no-*. For the late variant *simītur* (largely neglected in the literature), the claimed source in abl. sg. **simītūd* (with treatment as in OLat. APVR, ARFVISE, etc.) cannot be correct; Lindsay’s now-forgotten explanation based on 3sg. passive *ītur* is preferable, and can be elucidated further. The entirely neglected inscriptional form SEIMITVM (with metrically guaranteed light first syllable) may reflect yet another – and possibly earlier – variant, perhaps a univerbation of acc. sg. **semem eitum* (> **sem’eitum* > /simītum/) beside the abl. sg. phrase underlying *simītū*, cf. adverbial pairs like *prīmum* beside *prīmō.* The Celtic material sometimes compared with Lat. *simītū* is problematic, and does not authorize an Italo-Celtic prototype, at least *stricto sensu*.

1. Lat. simītū, simītur: background

A Latin adverb *simītū* ‘at the same time, together’ is attested with certainty eleven times in Plautus,[1] though it is often garbled in the manuscript tradition, transmitted as *simul*, *sim id*, *sime tu*, etc. The word is also found three or four times in other early poets: once (or twice) in Lucilius,[2] once (with some uncertainty) in Accius,[3] and once

[1] Nearly always in iambic or trochaic passages; in cantica only *Mos.* 792, *Tri.* 223 (both in bacchiacs, not surprisingly, given the metrical shape of the word). Four additional attestations listed by Lodge (1933:651, s.v.), three of them in cantica (all in non-bacchiac rhythm), are no longer accepted in modern editions. (The instance at *Am.* 631, in a passage that may be interpolated, is discussed below.)

[2] 1011 Marx (= 1092 Warmington, 1108 Krenkel); less certainly 315 Warmington (following Mueller) *ex coniectura* (hexameter line-end … *calda simeitu*), vs. 268 Marx (line-initial *calda siem …*, followed by Krenkel [269] and Charpin [VII.3]; codd. *caldais seme*).

[3] *trag.* 79 Ribb. = 42 Warmington, 232 Dangel, *ex coniectura* (codd. *simeta*); Klotz (1953:203) prefers Buecheler’s conjecture *sim ita*. (In defense of the metrical irregularity that would be introduced by *simītū* here: Dangel 1995:369.)

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in Pomponius.[4] An Imperial epitaph in hexameters may also have an instance of the word,[5] though (as discussed below) the situation there is not completely clear. Finally, a fragment of Suetonius[6] compares *simul* and *simītū*, assigning *simītū* a meaning like 'simul itu'.[7]

At some remove chronologically from OLat. *simītū* is the variant form *simītur* 'id.', attested several times in early Imperial epitaphs composed in (or emulating) hexameters; and one such text contains the problematic form SEIMITVM, possibly belonging with *simītū* and *simītur* and necessarily (on the basis of meter) reflecting either /sĕmītum/ or /sĭmītum/.[8] According to a conjecture of Ritschl,[9] *simītur* may also be read at the beginning of a poorly-transmitted iambic senarius by the literary critic Volcacius Sedigitus (1st c. BCE), in the "Vita Terentii" preserved in the manuscripts of Donatus and attributed to Suetonius. But modern scholars prefer the manuscript reading *sumetur*, and the remainder of the line requires emendation in any case;[10] we will thus have nothing further to say about this very doubtful instance.

Again according to Ritschl,[11] *simītur* might underlie one or more instances of *simītū* in the text of Plautus, especially at *Am.* 631,[12] where *simītur* (for transmitted *simītū*) would remove an instance of hiatus. But this theory must be regarded as highly improbable. There is, to begin with, no trace of *simītur* anywhere in the manuscript tradition of Plautus,[13] even allowing for the distorted manner in which *simītū* is often transmitted. Not only is *simītur* otherwise attested only much later, but (as we will see) the form also has, in all likelihood, a secondary origin that must post-date the period of Plautine comedy. Moreover, hiatus in that position of a trochaic septenarius (i.e., after the fourth-foot diaeresis between the *D* and *A* positions) is common in Plautus[14] and does not require emendation. Finally, *Am.* 631 itself

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[4] *com.* 100 Ribb. = 96 Frassinetti.
[5] *CLE* 422.7 = *CIL* VI 7578.7 (Rome).
[6] *Prata* 176 (Reifferscheid 1860:291).
[7] In other gloss literature simply *simitu* 'simul' (*CGL* V.647.53).
[8] The details of those attestations, along with the "stray" Imperial *simītū* just mentioned, will concern us below, in §6. Both *simītur* and (even more so) SEIMITVM are neglected in the secondary literature; neither, for example, is found in *EDLIL.*
[9] See, e.g., (Ritschl *apud*) Reifferscheid 1860:29.
[10] For the text, see Wessner 1902:5 (line 7), with apparatus; see further Rostagni 1944:34 and Carney 1963:9 (both *ad loc.*) for commentary on *sumetur* and the meaning of the passage.
[11] See most conveniently Ritschl 1868:258–9, citing his earlier work.
[12] *non ego cum vino simitu ebibi imperium tuom* (tr[7]).
[13] Noted already by Corssen (1863:400), arguing against Ritschl's earlier treatment of this material.
[14] See, e.g., Fortson 2008:78, with reference in n. 73.

occurs in a passage (629–31) that is generally regarded as interpolated.[15] Ritschl's two other alleged Plautine instances of *simītur* are no more attractive: *simitu aiebat* at *St.* 391 (tr[7]) scans perfectly well with elision and does not require Ritschl's conjectured *simitur aibat*; and at *Mos.* 792, the bacchiac tetrameter hemistich *simitu hau potui*, again with elision, reflects a rare but acceptable metrical variant,[16] which does not require the regularization that would be introduced by emending to *simitur.*

2. Lat. simītū: preliminary analysis

For *simītū*, the handbooks and lexica almost unanimously provide a preform "**sem-eitu-*";[17] thus *simītū* is taken to be the frozen ablative singular of a compound, with first member related to PIE **sem-* 'one (and the same)' and with second member reflecting the archaic full-grade *tu*-stem verbal noun of **h₁ei-* 'go' (i.e., **h₁éi-tu-*, in PIE terms),[18] yielding a literal sense 'at one (and the same) go(ing)', whence 'at the same time'.[19] The semantics seem impeccable, and the preservation of the archaic full grade of the verbal root is morphologically interesting: as often noted,[20] Latin has otherwise generalized the zero grade in every other *tu*-stem noun (or supine form) based on this root: thus *aditus* 'approach', *reditus* 'return', and a number of others, most of them attested from the time of Plautus.[21]

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[15] See Christenson 2000:249 (*ad* 631), with additional references.

[16] See Questa 2007:426–7 (his subtype "*a3*").

[17] So, e.g., *LEW* II.540 (s.v.), *DELL* 627 (s.v.), *IEW* 902, *EDLIL* 192 (s.v. *eō*), Weiss 2011:429 (but see below for another possibility mentioned by Weiss). Differently Dunkel, *LIPP* 2.721 (more on which below).

[18] Cf. the Vedic infinitives *étave* (RV+), *étum* (B.+); probably also RV *sváitu-* (5.41.9b, i.e., *svá-etu-*; Grassmann: 'eigenen, selbständigen Gang habend'), on which see Narten 1986:266 n. 59.

[19] On the full-grade verbal noun, see also Leumann-Hofmann 1928:236, 309 = Leumann 1963 (*ibid.*); and for identification of the form as a compound, see Bader 1962:239. The vowel-harmonic assimilation ("*i*-Umlaut") *e … ī > i … ī* in **semītū > simītū* is essentially regular: cf. **nemis > nimis* 'too much', **kenis > cinis* 'ash', etc. (Leumann 1977:101, Meiser 1998:81, Weiss 2011:138). But see further below (n. 51) on this part of the traditional explanation of the form.

[20] See again (n. 19) Leumann-Hofmann 1928 and Leumann 1963 (*locc. cit.*) for explicit notice of this point. (Oddly, discussion of *simītū* in this connection – or, apparently, in any connection – was removed from Leumann 1977.)

[21] Simplex *itus* occurs no earlier than Titinius (*com.* 117 Ribb.) and Lucretius (3.388), and is relatively rare. Although the point does not seem to have been made explicitly, one wonders whether this simplex may have been back-formed to the more frequent (and earlier-attested) compounds of the type just mentioned. Note in this connection the frequent asyndetic formulae involving *itus* in the sense 'right of

Something like this conception of *simītū* must be correct, *grosso modo*.[22] Nevertheless, the form is more problematic – or at least more ambiguous – than seems to be recognized. From the point of view of morphology, one may ask exactly what sort of compound formation is assumed in the alleged preform **sem-eitu-*. The immediate difficulty is that PIE **sem-* as first member of a compound almost always appears as zero grade **sm̥-* (cf. Ved. *sadyás* ‘today’; *sakŕt*, Gk. ἅπαξ ‘once’, etc.),[23] typically in bahuvrīhi compounds (Stüber 2004); and this, indeed, is often assumed for the background of a number of other Latin compounds, such as *semper* ‘always’, *simplex* ‘having one layer, simple’, *sincērus* ‘sound, whole’ and others.[24] The same feature applies to an alternative conception of *simītū*, according to which the ultimate etymon of the first member is rather **so(m)* ‘together’, again in its zero-grade variant **sm̥-*.[25]

Now the development of zero-grade **(s)m̥-* to Lat. *(s)em-* (often with pre-nasal raising of *e* to *i*, cf. *in* ‘in, into’ vs. OLat. EN < **en*) is regular before consonant. But there is no reason to think that the formation goes back to an actual PIE **sm̥-h₁ei-tu-*, with laryngeal still intact. For **(s)m̥-* before vowel: at least according to some scholars, the treatment is the same.[26] As I have argued, however,[27] the prevocalic treatment is different: as shown most clearly by *homō* ‘person’ (based on the prevocalic zero-grade stem-form of the PIE word for

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way, access’, of the type *itus aditus*, *itus ambitus*, *itus aditus ambitus*, etc., well-attested inscriptionally (see *TLL* s.v. *itus*, VII[2].4.569.62ff.). Still more rare as a simplex is the verbal noun *itiō* (Ter.+). The alleged verbal noun EINOM ‘outcome’ or (according to another view) ‘manners’ (< *‘going’) often seen (since Krogmann 1936) in the next-to-last sentence of the Duenos Inscription (*CIL* I[2] 4) is far from secure, as I have discussed elsewhere (1999:298–300).

[22] An unacceptable alternative account (that of Corssen) is reserved for discussion below (§3.). There is little to be gained from Wackernagel’s somewhat cryptic remarks on *simītū* (1944:229), comparing it to forms of the type *iniussū* ‘without command’, which he takes to be related ultimately to Sanskrit absolutives in *-tvā*. These may all certainly involve different types of instrumental endings based on *tu*-stems; but that does not help elucidate the formation of *simītū.*

[23] *LIPP* 2.675–7. The only exception appears to be **sém-ǵn(h₁)-o-* ‘einzeln geboren, Einling’ > Lat. *singulus* ‘individual’ (with dissimilation), among other forms (see *LIPP* 2.675) – unless Lat. *singulus* itself contains zero grade **sm̥-*, which is theoretically possible and sometimes claimed (e.g., Weiss 2011:365).

[24] See, e.g., *EDLIL* 553 (s.v. *sem-, sim-*), 565 (s.v. *sincērus*). Differently on *semper*: *LIPP* 2.673, more on which below.

[25] Thus Dunkel, *LIPP* 2.721. As Dunkel notes (*LIPP* 2.728), it is not always easy to distinguish formations built on **sm̥-* (← **sém-* ‘one’) and **sm̥-* (← **só(m)* ‘together’).

[26] See, e.g., Schrijver 1991:220, Meiser 1998:65.

[27] 1993:246–9 (cf. also 2011:273–4 against the version just mentioned), followed by Livingston 1997:33–4; similarly Weiss 2011:105.

'earth', i.e., *$d^h\acute{g}^h\dot{m}$-*V*), the immediate outcome of *$(C)\dot{m}V$- (with that syllabification) is /(C)omV-/ (which sometimes, as a result of later processes, develops to /(C)umV-/, cf. *humus* 'earth'). And according to still another view,[28] the prevocalic development is taken to be /am/. The outcomes for a preform *$s\dot{m}$-h_1*ei-tu*- (Transponat; the pre-Latin input form will have lost the prevocalic laryngeal) are thus as follows, according to these three conceptions:

(i) *$(C)\dot{m}V$- > /(C)emV-/: > pre-Lat. **semeitu*-
(ii) *$(C)\dot{m}V$- > /(C)omV-/: > pre-Lat. **someitu*-
(iii) *$(C)\dot{m}V$- > /(C)amV-/: > pre-Lat. **sameitu*-

Only the first yields Lat. *simītū* regularly; the others require an analogical adjustment of the vocalism – thus explicitly Dunkel, for (iii): *simītū* "[f]ür **samītū* … durch *i*-Umlaut oder Kontamination mit *simul*" (*LIPP* 2.721 n. 22). But "*i*-Umlaut" does not regularly apply to /a ... ī/ sequences (or, for that matter, to /o ... ī/ or /u ... ī/ sequences); and, while contaminations do of course occur, it would be preferable to avoid such an assumption.

3. Lat. simītur: preliminary analysis

The late variant form *simītur* seems clearly to represent a secondary development somehow based on OLat. *simītū*; but insofar as this neglected form and the problem of its background are addressed at all, one finds little but uncertainty and confusion. The laconic treatment in Walde-Hofmann (*LEW* II.540, s.v. *simītū*) rightly rejects the "agent-noun" theory of Zimmermann (1909:310),[29] and tentatively suggests that *simītur* derives from the early OLat. ablative **simītūd** (itself unattested, but the predictable precursor to *simītū*), with the *-d* > *-r* treatment seen in forms like APVR/*apor* 'apud',[30] ARFVISE 'adfuisse', ARVORSVM 'advorsum',[31] *arvehant* 'advehant',[32] *arferia (aqua)*,[33] etc.; and this suggestion is immediately followed by a reference to "Lindsay-Nohl 650" (i.e., Lindsay 1897:650) and "Stolz^4 124" (i.e., Stolz-Schmalz 1910:124). Thus Bader (1962:239 n. 109), citing *LEW*,

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[28] See the discussions by Leumann (1977:58–9) and Dunkel (*LIPP* 1.102).
[29] I.e., *simītur* as 'der Mitgeher, der Begleiter' (proposed without reference to *simītū*, which this theory cannot explain).
[30] *CIL* I^2 5 (late 4th/early 3rd c. BCE), P.F. 24.12L.
[31] ARFVISE, ARVORSVM: SCBacch (*CIL* I^2 581; 186 BCE).
[32] Cato, *Ag.* 138.
[33] P.F. 10.23L; cf. further Priscian and other grammarians on these forms (Weiss 2015:63, with references).

can perhaps be forgiven for retailing the same explanation with phrasing that credits both Lindsay and Stolz-Schmalz for this theory. Yet with regard to Lindsay, nothing could be farther from the truth, as Lindsay explicitly rejected this account. In his original English version,[34] Lindsay wrote: "The later (plebeian) form *simitur* can hardly be due to a change of *-d* to *-r* like that seen in O. Lat. *apor, apur* for *apud*". One can only agree with this judgment.[35] The improbable chronological gap between OLat. APVR *et sim.* and Imperial Lat. *simītur* (allegedly based on unattested *simītūd**) is almost fatal in itself.[36] More damaging still is the fact that the *-d* > *-r* pattern in question is at bottom a sandhi process, involving an assimilatory spirantization (hence, in context, APVR.FINEM in *CIL* I^2 5,[37] like ARFVISE, *arferia*, ARVORSVM, *arvehant*);[38] and the attested behavior of the word (typically line-final; further details below) offers not the slightest reason to believe that anything of the sort was operative with *simītur.* Lindsay in fact went on to suggest an alternative account: *simītur* "is more likely to be a corruption caused by confusion with the Impersonal *ītur*, 3 Sg. Pass. of *eo*, to go". This is far more attractive, and it may even be possible (§§6., 7.) to elaborate some of the details of this development.

It remains to mention, for the sake of completeness, Corssen's proposal that *simītū* goes back to an earlier **simītus*, built from an *o*-stem loc. sg. **semī* 'together' (like *domī* 'at home', *humī* 'on the ground', etc.) extended by the adverbial suffix *-tus* seen in Lat. *funditus* 'from the bottom', *caelitus* 'from heaven', and other such forms.[39] This is untenable for a variety of reasons,[40] and therefore offers no support to Corssen's further suggestion (1863:400) that this **simītus* could somehow have developed not only to *simītū* but also to *simītur*,

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[34] 1894:565, from which the German translation in Lindsay-Nohl does not deviate.

[35] Interestingly, there is no longer any trace of this theory in "Stolz-Schmalz^5" (= Leumann-Hofmann 1928).

[36] So also *LIPP* 2.721 n. 22. (The *d*-loss in such abl. sg. forms was complete by the time of Plautus; Weiss 2011:234.)

[37] If that traditional reading is correct; M. Crawford (*apud* Clackson-Horrocks 2007:112) reads APVD, apparently assuming that the final letter of the preposition is just a badly-formed D. But this does not affect the point at issue.

[38] On the process, see Leumann 1977:155 (with earlier references) and especially Wachter 1987:492–3.

[39] Corssen 1863:23, followed by Vaniček 1881:285.

[40] In short: there is no good evidence for a thematic **semo-* (whether to **sem-* 'one' or **so(m)* 'together'; see *LIPP* 2.675 [s.v. **sem-*] and 2.734 n. 37 [s.v. **so(m)*]), and a derivation consisting of "thematic loc. sg. + adv. **-tos*" is both morphologically anomalous and (given the ablatival meaning of **-tos*) semantically indefensible (on **-tos*, see *LIPP* 1.191–4); nor could such an adverbial form **simītus* (< **semei-tos*) account for the ending of OLat. *simītū.*

justified only by a vague comparison with *s*-less forms of the type Praen. MAIO, MINO (cognomina) (< **maiōs*, **minōs*) beside their Class. Lat. counterparts *maior*, *minor*.

4. Celtic comparanda[41]

Since the beginning of the 20th century, Lat. *simītū* has been compared with OIr. *emid/emith* 'nearly, as it were'[42] and MW *hefyd* 'also, too, similarly'.[43] The analysis of the Celtic material, however, is beset with difficulties and indeterminacies, only some of which need be sketched here.[44] It must be said, to begin with, that the connection of the Irish and Welsh forms with each other is not as self-evident as the handbooks seem to imply,[45] if only for syntactic and semantic reasons: *emid* is sentence-initial, with a concessive meaning like 'as it were', often occurring in coordinated contexts (*emid ... emid*), whereas *hefyd* has an augmentative meaning (basically 'too') and shows a predilection for clause-final position. Still, if one grants the connection, the most salient point about these forms is that they point to a Proto-Celtic **semĭt-* (with final syllable so far unspecified), the short /ĭ/ of which does not match (the original diphthong of) Lat. *simītū.* As for the final syllable: there are difficult issues here, especially on the Welsh side, which need not detain us; but at least the Irish spelling (with <i> in the final syllable) suggests that the final dental was palatalized, which in turn suggests a front vowel for the original final syllable – cf. *IEW* 902 ("aus **semiti-*, zu ai. *sám-iti-*", following Thurneysen for the Sanskrit comparison) and more recently Irslinger 2002:225 (Celtic **sem-ĭ-ti-*) and Matasović, *EDP–C* 329 (**semiti-*). The morphological interpretation of such a formation, however, remains unclear.[46] And indeed, the

[41] For expert guidance concerning the Celtic material (including some of the specific observations that follow), I am deeply indebted to A. Griffith, St. Schumacher, and D. Stifter.

[42] With regular *s*-loss in proclisis (*GOI* §178). The non-raising of **e* to /i/ in such a form can be ascribed to the intervening lenited *m* (Griffith 2012).

[43] Loth 1909:258–9 and 1917–19:59, Thurneysen 1901:39 (on W. *hefyd* only). The recent treatment of these words in *EDP–C* (329), more on which shortly, makes no mention either of *simītū* or of Thurneysen or Loth; and the treatment of *simītū* in *LIPP* (cf. above) does not mention the Celtic material.

[44] For a detailed etymological survey, see Irslinger 2002:224f. (though without reference to Thurneysen on the Welsh form).

[45] An exception is *GPC* (II.1837): the comparison of the Welsh form with OIr. *emid* is registered with a query.

[46] Irslinger's tentative suggestion (2002:226) of "eine Bildung mit einem Suffix **-iti-* zu idg. **sem* 'zusammen'" has no basis in inherited material. For Matasović,

Irish word has been given an entirely different analysis by Strachan (1900), who viewed the form as an imperative based on **eimid* ‘takes’ (either 2 pl., or 2 sg. with a suffixed particle).

Bader (1962:239 n. 110) admitted the discrepancy in the second-syllable vocalism between Lat. *simītū* and the Celtic material, yet still raised the possibility of a “prototype italo-celtique”. In view of the above considerations, this must be viewed with considerable skepticism. But we will return to this question briefly at the end of the paper (§8.).

5. Lat. simītū: further analysis

As already mentioned (§2., n. 17), Weiss has raised the possibility of an alternative to the traditional conception of *simītū* as a compound **sem-eitu-*, with full grade of the root in the verbal noun: “a preform **semi-itu-* cannot be ruled out” (2011:429 n. 18). Such a form would indeed, at first blush, seem to produce **semītu-* (> *simītu-*); but what sort of formation is envisioned here? The “first member” of what is written as a compound is apparently the loc. sg. in **-i* (> Lat. consonant-stem abl. sg. in *-e*) of PIE **sem-* ‘one (and the same)’; but this only makes sense in a phrasal combination with abl. sg. (originally instr. sg., for this declension class) of the verbal noun – thus rather **semi + itū.* This, in its turn, is hardly a “compound”: Lat. *simītū* must be seen as a univerbation of an original phrase **semi itū* ‘in one (and the same) go(ing)’, from a time when the loc. sg. form (> Lat. abl. sg.) still ended in **-i*.[47] As such, a univerbation analysis handily addresses all of the problems outlined above with approaches based on compounds. And in addition to these, note further Bader’s observation (1962:239) on the virtual non-existence of *u*-stem compounds in Latin.[48]

There is, however, the probability that a univerbation applying to a sequence **semi itū* would have led not to contraction, but rather to

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who describes the formation as “puzzling”, the second element **-iti-* (following a suggestion of A. Lubotsky) “may, perhaps, be compared with Skt. *iti* ‘thus’”. But Skt. *íti* < **í-th$_2$* (see, e.g., *LIPP* 2.368) should have come out as Pr.-Celt. **-ita*, which poses problems at least for the Irish form. Nor, for an item like PIE **sem-*, is there any real likelihood of an athematic **sem-it-*.

[47] In theory, one could consider the possibility of a phrase **seme itū* (with the “new” abl. sg. in *-e*), which might have coalesced into **semeitū*, with medial diphthong. But I have not been able to find a parallel for such a coalescence, and other options (see the immediately following discussion) seem more attractive.

[48] Apart from forms with preverb (such as supines), there is only *tribus* ‘division of 3’ < **tri-d^{h}h$_1$-u-* (see *EDLIL* s.v. on the etymology, with reference).

elision – cf. the elision treatment for univerbated phrases where the contiguous vowel quality is the same, of the type *magnopere* 'greatly' (< *magnō opere*), *anteā* 'formerly' (< *ante eā*), *potest* 'is possible' (< *pote est*).[49] For **semi itū*, then, one might expect a univerbated outcome **sem'itū* > †*simĭtū*, rather than *simītū.* For this reason, and also because of the late and possibly secondary nature of simplex *itus* itself (n. 21 above), I suggest (lightly modifying Weiss's alternative proposal) that *simītū* derives from a univerbated phrase that does indeed contain the old full-grade form of the verbal noun, either (in pre-Latin terms) **semi eitū(d)* or (in early Latin terms, with the "new" abl. sg. form) **seme eitū(d)*, in both cases ending up as **sem'eitū(d)* (with elision and univerbation),[50] whence **semeitū*, then **semītū*, and finally OLat. *simītū.*[51] The isolated status of this frozen adverbial form, almost entirely (or perhaps entirely, cf. §6.) restricted to the most archaic period of the literary language, is favorable for the retention of linguistic archaisms, which (according to this proposal) turn out to be of two types. In addition to the full-grade *tu*-stem, we would also have a rare trace of the inflected form of **sem-* 'one' (i.e., pre-Lat. loc. sg. **sem-i* or Lat. abl. sg. **seme* = Gk. dat. sg. ἑνί), otherwise (apart from its use as first compound member in forms like *simplex, simplus, sincērus,* etc., and possibly in a few other frozen forms) entirely eclipsed as a free form of the numeral by **(h$_1$)oi-no-* 'one'. This can be compared, then, to Lat. *mīlle* 'thousand' (pl. *mīlia* < **smih$_2$ ǵh(e)slih$_2$*),[52] and perhaps also (following Dunkel, *LIPP* 2.673) Lat. *semper* 'always' and *semel* 'once', if these incorporate univerbated neut. acc. **sém* followed by various particles. As a technical possi-

[49] For discussion of this pattern, see Weiss 2011:133 with n. 48.

[50] For another possible instance of prehistoric univerbation with elision, see Garnier 2014 on Ital. **né=χ(e)=áyud*.

[51] There is a potential chronological problem raised by this sequence, as well as by the traditional etymology, given the fact that for etymological **ei* Plautus probably still wrote <ei> and may have pronounced both the newer monophthong /ę̄/ as well as the older /ei/, at least as a stylistic variant (Gerschner 2002:73). In that case, if the form of *simītū* really results from "*i*-Umlaut" (n. 19 above; thus explicitly, comparing *nimis*, e.g. *DELL* s.v. *simītū*), this could not have occurred until after the time of Plautus, in which case the *simītū* of our texts reflects a modernization of Plautine <semeitu> or <semetu>. This is possible, given (as noted at the outset) the vagaries of the MS transmission of the form, including, e.g., *seme*, *sime tu*, *simeta*. As an alternative, however, it may be preferable to conceive of the development of the first syllable as comparable to the "enclitic weakening" seen in the first syllable of pronominal forms like *mihi*, *sibi*, etc. (Leumann 1977:88, Weiss 2011:327), with the "weakening" here (i.e., **sem'eitū(d)* > "Plautine" *simeitū* or *simētū*) a concomitant result of the univerbation. (On "irregular reduction" as a by-product of univerbation in temporal adverbs, see recently Hackstein 2014.)

[52] Meiser 1998:174, Weiss 2011:373–4; typically written as a compound, but rather univerbated.

bility, finally, one could consider, at a deeper IE level, an original "instrumental + instrumental" sequence, i.e. (virtual) **sém-eh$_1$* + **h$_1$éi-tu-h$_1$* > pre-Lat. **sem'(ē) eitū*. But evidence for instrumental **sém-eh$_1$* is restricted to Myc. *e-me* (PY Ta 641), more often interpreted as dat. /hem-ei/ rather than instr. /hem-ē/. And in any case, the Latin material is better viewed in terms of a more "shallow" background.[53]

6. Lat. simītur: further analysis

As noted in §1., a "stray" instance of *simītū* is said to be attested in a late epitaph (see n. 5), at a time and in a genre where otherwise the variant *simītur* is exclusively attested (apart from the form SEIMITVM, to be treated below). Line 7 of the poem (memorializing a boy), one of a number of correct dactylic hexameters (beside several faulty ones), is said to read *planctibus heu miserae matris patrisque simitu* ("with the wailing of my poor mother and at the same time of my father"), for which Buecheler (*CLE ad loc.*) reasonably comments "*simitu* Plautinum". But in fact, the stone contains, in addition to the inscribed text, the figure of a boy in relief with his right arm outstretched, in such a way that his arm covers the bottom of the <V> of SIMITV as well as the space directly following it.[54] Moreover, the lettering of line 7 is extremely compressed. Thus, one might just as easily imagine that the copy text had SIMITVR, though the available space allowed only for SIMITV (i.e., more accurately transcribed, SIMITṾ[).

Still, even if one grants that this is a bona fide late attestation of *simītū* (as it might be), Buecheler might more appropriately have identified the usage here as "Lucilianum" rather than "Plautinum": this is, after all, a hexameter text, and the form appears at line-end, exactly as with the one clear instance of *simītū* in a hexameter verse of Lucilius (n. 2 above):

gratia habetur utrisque, illisque tibique simitu[55]
"gratitude is offered to both, to them and at the same time to you"

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[53] For this reason, the innovatory loc. sg. **sem-i* is to be expected, rather than the primordial locative with lengthened grade ("endingless" **sḗm* or hypercharacterized **sḗm-i*; see Dunkel 2.672 [s.v. **sém-*] and 2.681 [s.v. **sēmí-*]).

[54] A photograph of *CIL* VI 7578 can easily be viewed via the *CIL* search page (http://cil.bbaw.de/cil_en/dateien/datenbank_eng.php).

[55] Lindsay (Non. 175M = 257.16L) *simeitu* (cf. codd. *simetu*); *tibique ex. coni.* (codd. *sibique*). Note also that the second (less certain) example of *simītū* in Lucilius may also have occurred at the end of a hexameter line (see again n. 2 above).

Lucilius indisputably lifted *simītū* from Plautus;[56] but the Imperial poet, using the word (or possibly *simītur*) to emphasize two items conjoined by *-que* (… *matris patrisque simitu*[*r*ʔ] #, cf. Lucil. … *illisque tibique simitu* #), may have been more influenced by Lucilius than by Plautus, who in fact never uses this coordinate structure with *simītū*. Another Imperial epitaph[57] shows *simītur* (and here the reading is clear) again in line-final position in a hexameter, and again emphasizing a two-part expression with *-que*:

abstulit una dies anima(m) corpusq(ue) sim[it]ur
"a single day took away her soul and at the same time her body"

If one notices, next, that the Lucilian line actually opens with *gratia habetur*, it does not seem too far-fetched to imagine that the later poetic tradition could have produced a folk-etymological adjustment of the (by that time) obscure adverb *simītū* into a corresponding 3sg. pass. "*simītur*", parallel to 3sg. *habetur*, along the lines of

gratia habetur utrisque, illisque tibique "simitur"
"gratitude is offered to both, [i.e.] it applies (lit. 'goes') at the same time to them and to you"

with "*simītur*" interpreted as a compound of *simul* and 3sg. (impersonal) pass. *ītur*;[58] compare the Suetonian gloss *simītū* 'simul itu' (§1.), which helps authorize "*simītur* = *simul ītur*", as well as the fact that 3sg. pass. *ītur* is well-attested in Classical hexameter poetry, including a clutch of instances at line-end.[59] This is, of course, merely an elaborated version of Lindsay's tentative proposal about the background of *simītur* (§3.).[60]

One final attestation of *simitur* is found in an Imperial epitaph,[61] where the poetic portion of the text begins:

HILARA.MINOR.MIDAES.MIN
ISTRA.SIMITVR.CVM.MIDA
SITA.EST.IN.EADEM.OLLA …

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[56] So explicitly Marx 1905:326, *ad loc.*
[57] *CLE* 405.5 = *CIL* X 174.5 (Potenza).
[58] Also with preverb: e.g., ADEITVR *CIL* I^2 1606, and *adītur* about 15x in Classical literature.
[59] Virg. *Aen.* 12.528, App. Virg. *Aetna* 8, Manil. 5.374, Ov. *F.* 4.443, Juv. 1.89.
[60] Comparison with *ītur* is entertained as a possibility also by Dunkel (*LIPP* 2.721 n. 22), who nevertheless prefers to envision influence from other Latin *r*-adverbs. Among these, however, the only serious candidate is really *igitur* 'therefore', which lacks much connection (apart from *-tur*) with *simītur.*
[61] *CLE* 365 = *CIL* VI 9290 (Rome).

The first two lines can be read with dactylic rhythm, as with many epitaphs that attempt (in this case with little success) to emulate hexameter poetry.[62]

7. Lat. "S{E}IMITVM"

More interesting – and more difficult – is the form SEIMITVM, in the third line of *CLE* 429,[63] a competent poem consisting of ten metrically perfect hexameters:

vixi ego bis denos annos tres atque seimitum
"I lived for twenty-three years and *seimitum*"

CIL ad loc. (essentially following Buecheler, in *CLE*) comments: "*seimitum* qui carmen pegit idem significare voluit ac *semis*, recordatus fortasse verbi obsoleti eius, quod est *simitu*, prorsus aliam sane habentis notionem".[64] But SEIMITVM (necessarily scanned "*sĭmītum*" or "*sĕmītum*") cannot be any form of *sēmis* (often indeclinable, otherwise with gen. sg. *sēmissis*), lit. 'half (of an *as*-piece)', and sometimes 'half (of anything)'. Here is Buecheler's (typically laconic) formal explanation: "seimitum pro semato semisse accipio, cf. unitus unatus, artitus artatus al. Corripitur vocalis quasi in selibra".[65] In other words, Buecheler imagines a metrically-shortened participle *sĕmītum* 'halved', based on a denominative verb "*sēmīre*" or "*sēmāre*" 'to halve' (cf. *sēmi-* 'half'). But this is scarcely credible. First of all, the verbs "*sēmīre*" and "*sēmāre*" are almost entirely fictional: "*sēmīre*", as far as I can determine, does not exist; and a Latin "*sēmāre*", supported only by a hapax gloss-form,[66] exists mainly as a source for Romance forms.[67] Nor are the parallels Buecheler cites particularly supportive.[68] To be sure, the metrical shortening in forms like *sĕlībra* 'half pound'

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[62] The text is included in *CLE* among hexameter poems.
[63] *CIL* VIII 21179 (Mauretania).
[64] "The inscriber of the poem meant for *seimitum* to have the same meaning as *semis* ('one-half'), perhaps recalling the obsolete word *simitu*, which, to be sure, has quite a different sense".
[65] "I interpret *seimitum* (perf. participle) as standing for *sematum* (beside perf. infin.) *semisse*, cf. *unitus* (beside) *unatus*, *artitus* (beside) *artatus*, and other such forms. The (first) vowel (of *sĕmītum*) is shortened as in *selibra*".
[66] *sēmātum* 'ἡμίκενον, ἀπηρμένον' (*CGL* II.181.45).
[67] *REW* 643 s.v. **sēmāre* 'halbieren'.
[68] Both *ūnīre* and *ūnāre* 'join, make one' (: *ūnus* 'one') are attested only late and very rarely; *artāre* 'compress' (: *artus* 'tight') is well attested (Pl.+), but *artīre* 'insert tightly; fit tight' is restricted (apart from glosses) to a few occurrences in Cato and Novius (fl. early 1st c. BCE).

(so treated regularly by Martial [5x], vs. correct *sēlībra*) is a real phenomenon, particularly prominent in dactylic cadences.[69] But this is a relatively late phenomenon (mostly Virg.+, and prominently with onomastic forms), and is thus at odds with the archaizing technique of this poem (cf. line 10, which concludes ... *pondus gravatum* #, with Ennian-style *s*-loss). Finally, I can find no parallel for this extraordinarily precise and syntactically questionable expression of the deceased woman's age ("I lived to be twenty-three and a half years old", i.e., literally "two tens of years (and) three, and also a halved [scil. year]"). Buecheler in fact went on to offer an alternative, which I think is actually much better: "Minus probabile est nihil dici nisi *simul*, quippe cum nihil differat ab *simitu*".[70] In that case, SEIMITVM 'simītū' (for /sĭmītum/; more below on the orthography) would belong (if somewhat loosely) with the following line (4):

> *vixi ego bis denos annos tres atque seimitum*
> *coniugis opsequio semper placuis(s)e iu(v)abat*[71]
> "I lived for twenty-three years, and together/at the same time [i.e. "during that time", or perhaps "with my husband"?]
> it was gratifying always to have pleased my husband with my obedience".

with, in terms of expression, line-final ... *(at)que seimitum* # much like ... *(patris)que simitu*[*r*?] #, ... *(tibi)que simitu* #, and ... *(corpus)q(ue) sim*[*it*]*ur* # (cf. above).[72]

How, then, should the form SEIMITVM be interpreted? Orthographically, one must assume that at least SEIMIT- incorporates an error, which could in principle be understood in two different ways. It could be an anticipatory error for intended SIMEITVM, with the common archaizing spelling of <EI> for [ī] (although the diphthongal spelling, in this case, would be etymologically correct, if perhaps accidentally). Compare, in the same text, SEIC 'sīc' (2x) and NOBEIS 'nōbīs', both with the same (etymologically correct) archaizing spellings; and the archaizing impulse is also visible in the non-geminated spellings PLACVISE and IVABAT. But the text also contains the hypercorrect (i.e., hyperarchaizing) LEGEISTI 'lēgistī', which raises the possibility that

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[69] See, e.g., Leumann 1977:115f., with additional examples. Two of Martial's five instances of *sĕlībra* are in dactylic cadences (5.19.11, 10.57.1), and a third is in the pentameter line of an elegiac couplet (8.71.8). The other two are in hendecasyllabic cadences (1.99.15, 4.46.7).

[70] "Less likely is that what is being said is merely *simul*, even though this would be no different from *simitu*".

[71] Cf. *CIL ad loc.*: "*coniugis obsequio* pro *coniugi* cet.".

[72] Most lines in the poem are end-stopped, but there is a similar enjambement at lines 7–8.

SEIMITVM is a similar hypercorrect spelling, i.e., with <EI> rendering the [ĭ] of *simītum.*[73]

The ending -VM also calls for explanation. One could simply suppose that this, too, is an error, with <-M> for <-R>; and in support, one could point to the other errors in the text: the very next verse begins FATORVM CVRSVM PROPERANS, where it is clear from the syntax that CVRSVM is an error for nom. sg. CVRSVS (again: a mistaken -M, perhaps perseverated from the preceding FATORVM, thus here also SEIMITVM?); and each of the last two verses has an instance of SIC written for SIT (3sg. pres. subjunctive of *sum*). So perhaps we have another example (though botched) of line-final *simītur* in a hexameter verse, and that is the end of the story. Still, one hesitates to admit that an originally intended SIMITVR has been mangled so thoroughly (with *two* errors), as opposed to the less extreme problems seen elsewhere in the text, as in LEGEISTI (for *lēgistī*), CVRSVM (for *cursus*), and SIC (for *sit*). If, then, one takes at face value the apparent form "*simītum*", it is possible to propose (with all due reserve) a linguistic explanation, as follows. What underlies *simītū* 'at the same time, together', no matter how one reconstructs the morphological details, is an ablatival expression comparable in some degree to adverbial ablatives like *prīmō* 'at first', *postrēmō* 'at last'. But such forms often occur with parallel adverbial accusatives, which, while semantically distinct from the ablative at least at first, can also take on the ablative sense: thus *prīmum* 'for the first time', but also (like *prīmō*) 'at first', and *postrēmum* 'for the last time', but also (like *postrēmō*) 'at last'.[74] One can therefore suppose that beside the original ablative phrase – according to the above theory, **sem(i) eitū* or **sem(e) eitū* 'at a single go', whence (with elision) univerbated **sem'eitū* – there also developed an "adverbial accusative" byform **sem(em) eitum* 'for (the extent of) a single go' (and eventually also 'at a single go'), whence (with elision) univerbated **sem'eitum* > **semītum*, and finally the *simītum* of our text.[75] To push this theory one step further, one could even suppose that the isolated hapax "*simītum*" may in fact be the more archaic of the two post-OLat. inscriptional forms belonging with OLat. *simītū* –

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[73] <EI> for [ĭ]: e.g. INTERIEISTI *CIL* I^2 1603 (early 1st c. BCE), SEINE 'sine' *CIL* I^2 583.54 (Lex. Repetund., 123/122 BCE), etc.; Leumann 1977:64.

[74] See on these forms Ernout-Thomas 1953:28, 100.

[75] For univerbation with elision of this type, cf. *vēnīre* 'go for sale' (< *vēn(um) īre*), *animadvertere* 'notice' (< *anim(um) advertere*). Or, if one prefers: one could think of haplology in the sequence **sem(em) eitum*. Note once again (cf. n. 51) that the sequence might instead have gone **sem'eitum* > (*)*simeitum* (perhaps directly reflected in an intended SIMEITVM in our text? see above) > *simītum.*

and indeed, *CLE* 429 is clearly the oldest such text, and possibly even a late Republican production (cf. Buecheler *ad loc.* on the dating).

That chronology, in turn, raises two further possibilities. First, one could speculate that it was actually the form *simītum* that was the direct source of *simītur* itself. In other words, the acc. version *simītum*[76] would have developed, in the spoken language or perhaps rather in its ordinary metrical usage, to *simītũ*, with regular *m*-loss and nasalization of the preceding vowel. It could have been this form, with the metrical shape ∪ – ∪ and word-final *-tŭ* (with nasalization), or at least a "half-long" version of that syllable (vs. the *-tū* of *simītū*), that served as the basis for the reanalyzed *simītŭr* influenced by 3sg. *ītur*.[77] Finally, a relatively old *simītum* raises the question of whether such a form (unlike *simītur*, cf. §1.) could have existed in Early Latin, side by side with *simītū.* This could perhaps be considered for several passages in which transmitted sequences … *simitu m-* could in principle recover original *… *simītum m-*,[78] only later reinterpreted to contain *simītū*: Pl. *Ps.* 1012 *simitu mulierem*, Acc. *simitu miseritudo*, Pompon. *simitu manducatur*. But this is no more than a theoretical possibility.

*8. Concluding remarks (Pr.-Celt. *semĭt- and Lat. simītū)*

If, as argued above (§4.), there is little likelihood of a "prototype italo-celtique" (Bader's tentative suggestion), what can be said about the interpretation of the Celtic forms vis-à-vis Lat. *simītū*, if one assumes a relationship based somehow on PIE **sem-* 'one (and the same)' and **h₁ei-* 'go'? The Latin *tu*-stem is simply incompatible with (at least) OIr. *emid/emith*, which (as we saw) points to an original final syllable with front vowel; and the original full-grade vocalism of the Latin form contrasts with the Celtic /ĩ/ (cf. Thurneysen's comparison of the Welsh form with Ved. *íti-* 'going'). Thus at best, we may have two roughly comparable expressions based on a collocation involving PIE **sem-* and different verbal nouns belonging to **h₁ei-* 'go', which –

[76] Or, to consider earlier stages and alternative possibilities (cf. n. 51), **semītum*, **semeitom*, **simeitom*, etc.; for expository convenience, I dispense with such alternatives in the immediately following discussion.

[77] On the possibility that the nasalized vowel resulting from *m*-loss may have been long or half-long, see Allen 1978:30–1, 119, and (in more detail, with additional references) Weiss 2015:25. The *m*-loss process, while often assigned to some version of non-elite or low-register speech (see, e.g., Väänänen 1981:66–7), is in fact not restricted to "lower sociolects" and simply belongs to the spoken language (Adams 2013:128–32).

[78] Conceivably spelled <… SIMEITVM- …> in early non-geminating orthography with *scriptio continua*.

even if independently formed – might still be of some limited “Italo-Celtic” interest. And if a comparison in those terms is valid, possibly even involving a univerbation on the Celtic side, Pr.-Celt. **sem-it(i̯)(-))* might then provide some limited support for the above interpretation of Lat. *simītū* as based on an actual **sem-*, with old *e*-grade, rather than the zero-grade first compound member **sm̥-* that one might otherwise expect.[79]

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